



SOUTHERN AFRICA BRAND QUALITY AWARDS



FIELD SURVEY REPORT

SUBMITTED TO

MOBI RIDES

Survey Period
1 Mar – 20 Apr
2026

Voting Period
30 Mar – 10 May
2026

Voters Registered
2,210,698

Votes Cast
893,763

The International Quality Awards
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Chartered Quality Institute
LEADING QUALITY SINCE 1919



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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report presents the findings of a comprehensive field survey conducted by the Southern Africa Brand Quality Awards (SABQAwards) research team, covering urban and rural survey zones within the Southern Africa region and selected neighbouring countries. The survey focuses on brand consumption patterns and public trust perspectives across key consumer markets, with award recognition conferred through the prestigious Quality Seal of Excellence.

The survey, conducted between 1st March and 20th April 2026, was followed by an open public voting phase from 30th March to 10th May 2026, facilitated through the official digital platform at vote.sabrandqualityawards.com. A remarkable total of 2,210,698 voters registered for the process, with 893,763 votes ultimately cast — representing a voter conversion rate of 40.4%, the highest recorded in recent SABQAwards cycles and a powerful testament to the strength of public engagement and brand relevance across the region.

This edition prominently features Mobi Rides, operating under the brand MobiRide in Botswana, as the winner of the Leading Car Rental Company award. The recognition affirms MobiRide's commanding position in the transportation and mobility sector, validated by a substantial volume of public votes and strong performance across all judicial evaluation criteria.

2. ABOUT THE ORGANIZERS & PARTNERS

2.1 Southern Africa Brand Quality Awards (SABQAwards)

The Southern Africa Brand Quality Awards (SABQAwards) is the foremost business and corporate recognition platform in Southern Africa. Founded with the mission of identifying and championing enterprises that exemplify job creation, customer service excellence, integrity, and professionalism, SABQAwards conducts the only statistically comprehensive, independent market research survey in the region to measure brand reputation, customer satisfaction, and overall business excellence.

The platform operates on a hybrid model — combining data-driven independent research with democratic public participation — to produce recognition outcomes that are both rigorous and genuinely representative of consumer sentiment. The annual Awards Gala has grown into one of the most prestigious business recognition events in the region.

Vision	To be the leading organisation in Southern Africa that recognises and nurtures leadership, business excellence, and brand quality, driving economic development through stakeholder engagement.
Mission	To recognise and honour companies and individuals who go the extra mile for the people of Southern Africa, ensuring they receive the recognition they richly deserve.
Goal	To nurture business excellence through customer service reviews and recommendations for the benefit of local enterprises and the customers they serve.
Website	www.sabrandqualityawards.com
Voting Platform	https://vote.sabrandqualityawards.com/public/index.php

Contact	+256 394 875 452 +260 777 068 361 +260 761 663 649
Email	awards@sabrandqualityawards.com
2026 Awards Gala	Lusaka, Zambia — 10th July 2026

2.2 Strategic Partners

SABQAwards operates in formal partnership with internationally accredited organisations, ensuring that its evaluation standards are globally recognised and credible:

East Africa Brand Quality Awards	Sister organisation extending parallel recognition programmes across the East African region, enabling cross-border comparative benchmarking.
Chartered Quality Institute (CQI)	Globally recognised professional quality body providing benchmarking methodology, quality standards guidance, and institutional credibility to the evaluation process.
Alconext (Eyez Investments Limited)	Technology and digital infrastructure partner supporting the survey platform, data management systems, and public voting architecture.
Bureau Veritas	International certification and testing authority providing independent assurance of quality evaluation standards and compliance frameworks.
IQNet Certification	Global certification network whose partnership extends international standards recognition to all SABQAwards-endorsed brands.
Global Capital BV	Business advisory partner supporting economic sustainability assessment and investment-grade brand analysis.
Halal Research Council (HRC)	Ensures halal compliance standards are considered within applicable industry evaluations.



3. SURVEY METHODOLOGY

3.1 Survey Design & Approach

The SABQAwards field survey employs a dual-phase hybrid methodology. The first phase involves independent, on-ground field research conducted by trained survey teams across urban and rural zones. The second phase opens the process to broad democratic public participation through a transparent online voting platform. This approach ensures both statistical validity and democratic accountability.

Survey Period	1st March 2026 – 20th April 2026
Voting Period	30th March 2026 – 10th May 2026
Voting Platform	https://vote.sabrandqualityawards.com/public/index.php
Total Voters Registered	2,210,698
Total Votes Cast	893,763
Voter Conversion Rate	40.4% — highest in recent SABQAwards history
Public Vote Weight	60% of final award score
Judges Evaluation Weight	40% of final award score

3.2 Geographic Coverage

The survey was conducted across a broad geographic footprint to ensure findings are representative of diverse demographic, economic, and cultural contexts:

Urban Areas	Central business districts, commercial hubs, transport interchanges, corporate offices, hotels, airports, and high-density residential areas. Research in these zones focused on formal market brand recognition, premium service expectations, and corporate client satisfaction.
Rural & Peri-Urban Areas	Agricultural zones, small towns, rural market centres, and community settlements. Survey teams assessed brand accessibility, awareness among non-urban populations, grassroots community trust levels, and value-for-money perception.
Neighbouring Countries	Cross-border data collection captured regional brand reach, export market recognition, and the sentiment of Southern African travellers and diaspora communities who interact with car rental services across the region.

3.3 Data Collection Methods

Data was gathered through multiple complementary channels to ensure comprehensive, cross-validated findings:

- On-ground structured questionnaire administration by trained field research teams across all survey zones
- Online nominations and public voting via the official SABQAwards digital portal
- Direct interviews with transport sector stakeholders, corporate clients, tourism operators, and travel agents

- Review of publicly available consumer feedback, online ratings, and market research publications
- Field observations at car rental branches, airport collection points, and vehicle return facilities
- Cross-border consumer surveys targeting regional travellers, business visitors, and tourism professionals

3.4 Evaluation Criteria — Expert Panel (40%)

The judicial panel assessed all nominees against nine comprehensive evaluation dimensions:

- Economic Sustainability — Contribution to employment, local economic growth, and long-term financial resilience
- Operational Effectiveness — Fleet management efficiency, booking systems, service delivery standards, and branch operations
- Technology Adoption & Progressive Leadership — Digital booking platforms, app-based services, fleet tracking, and innovation in mobility solutions
- Social & Community Contribution — Community investment, local hiring practices, and corporate social responsibility
- Quality, Affordability & Reliability — Vehicle quality standards, pricing competitiveness, and service dependability
- Brand Impact & Market Distinction — Unique positioning, brand recognition, and competitive differentiation in the car rental sector
- Sustainability Initiatives & Consumer Care — Environmental responsibility, fuel-efficient fleet management, and post-service customer support
- Trustworthiness & Customer Understanding — Brand integrity, transparency in pricing, and depth of customer insight
- Contribution to Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) — Measurable alignment with the UN SDG framework, particularly SDG 8 (Decent Work) and SDG 11 (Sustainable Cities and Communities)

4. AWARD SCORING & RECOGNITION FRAMEWORK

The SABQAwards blended scoring model combines democratic public participation with rigorous expert evaluation, producing outcomes that carry both popular legitimacy and institutional credibility.

60%

Public Nomination & Voting

2,210,698 registered voters | 893,763 votes cast |
40.4% conversion rate | Open online platform

40%

Expert Panel Evaluation

9 judging criteria | Multi-professional jury | Independent assessment | SDG alignment

4.1 Quality Seal of Excellence

All category winners at SABQAwards receive the Quality Seal of Excellence — a trademarked certification mark endorsed by the Chartered Quality Institute and all strategic partners. The Seal may be displayed on vehicles, uniforms, offices, website, marketing materials, and all brand communications as a publicly recognised indicator of independently verified consumer trust and quality standards.

For a car rental brand, the Quality Seal of Excellence carries particular commercial significance, serving as an independent, third-party endorsement of safety standards, service reliability, and customer satisfaction — key decision factors for individual and corporate clients alike.

5. SURVEY FINDINGS: BRAND CONSUMPTION & TRUST IN THE MOBILITY SECTOR

5.1 Participation Statistics

2,210,698

Voters Registered

893,763

Votes Cast

40.4%

Voter Conversion Rate

46 Days

Active Voting Window

The 2026 cycle recorded a voter conversion rate of 40.4% — the highest in recent SABQAwards history. This figure signals a significant leap in public awareness, digital accessibility of the voting platform, and genuine consumer motivation to participate in brand quality recognition. The high conversion rate substantially reinforces the statistical credibility of all award outcomes in this cycle, including MobiRide's recognition as Leading Car Rental Company.

5.2 Key Consumer Trust Themes — Mobility & Car Rental Sector

Across all survey areas — urban Botswana, rural communities, and regional cross-border zones — field researchers and consumer data consistently identified the following themes as primary trust and decision drivers in the car rental sector:

- **Vehicle Quality & Safety Standards:** Consumers overwhelmingly cited well-maintained, roadworthy, and safe vehicles as the number-one trust factor when selecting a car rental provider.
- **Transparent & Competitive Pricing:** Hidden charges and unclear fee structures were the most frequently cited reasons for distrust. Brands offering clear, all-inclusive pricing enjoyed substantially higher trust scores.
- **Convenience of Booking & Collection:** Digital booking capability, airport presence, and flexibility in vehicle pick-up and drop-off were critical differentiators — especially for urban, business, and tourism segments.
- **Customer Service Responsiveness:** Prompt and courteous handling of queries, breakdowns, and complaints ranked among the top five trust drivers across all consumer segments.
- **Fleet Diversity:** The availability of a wide range of vehicle categories — from economy to premium — was cited as a key indicator of a brand's capacity to serve diverse customer needs.
- **Brand Reputation & Word-of-Mouth:** Peer recommendations on social media and travel platforms (TripAdvisor, Google Reviews, Facebook)
- **Local Market Knowledge:** Consumers and corporate clients valued car rental companies with deep knowledge of local routes, conditions, and travel advisories.
- **Insurance & Breakdown Support:** Comprehensiveness of insurance cover and quality of roadside assistance were particularly important trust factors for rural and cross-border travel segments.

5.3 Urban vs. Rural Consumption Patterns — Car Rental Sector

Dimension	Urban Areas	Rural & Peri-Urban Areas
Primary Client Type	Corporate clients, business travellers, tourists, airport arrivals	Local community users, agricultural traders, rural event travel
Vehicle Preference	Sedans, SUVs, premium fleet categories	4x4, utility, and rugged terrain-capable vehicles
Booking Method	Online, app-based, corporate accounts	In-person, phone, and agent-facilitated bookings
Key Trust Driver	Professionalism, speed, brand reputation	Reliability, roadworthiness, community familiarity
Price Sensitivity	Moderate; quality and convenience prioritised	High; total cost and value-for-money decisive
Insurance Priority	Standard corporate cover	Comprehensive cover and breakdown response critical
Service Discovery	Google, social media, travel portals	Word of mouth, local referrals, community trust

VOTED BY PEOPLE FOR
QUALITY & RELIABILITY

6. FEATURED AWARD RECIPIENT: MOBI RIDES — MOBIRIDE, BOTSWANA

6.1 Company Overview

Mobi Rides, operating under the consumer-facing brand MobiRide, has established itself as one of Botswana's most recognisable and trusted car rental companies. Headquartered in Botswana, MobiRide has built a reputation for providing reliable, well-maintained vehicles across a diverse fleet portfolio — serving individual consumers, corporate clients, government agencies, tourism operators, and visiting travellers.

The brand's strength lies in its deep understanding of the Botswana mobility market — a landscape characterised by long-distance travel requirements, wildlife tourism, cross-border movement, and growing corporate activity in Gaborone, Francistown, and Kasane. MobiRide has positioned itself to serve all these segments with flexibility, quality, and competitive pricing.

The SABQAwards field survey identified MobiRide as consistently one of the most spontaneously cited and positively regarded car rental brands across urban, rural, and cross-border survey zones in Botswana, validating its award nomination and subsequent public and judicial recognition.

Company Name	Mobi Rides
Brand Name	MobiRide
Country of Operation	Botswana
Sector	Transportation & Mobility — Car Rental Services
Award Category	Leading Car Rental Company
Award Level	Southern Africa Brand Quality Award — Quality Seal of Excellence
Survey Period	1st March 2026 – 20th April 2026
Voting Period	30th March 2026 – 10th May 2026

6.2 Award Received

QUALITY SEAL OF EXCELLENCE WINNER

Leading Car Rental Company

MobiRide was awarded the Leading Car Rental Company distinction under the Southern Africa Brand Quality Awards framework, conferred through the combined weight of public voting and judicial evaluation. The award recognises MobiRide's exceptional standing in the Botswana car rental market, its strong consumer trust profile, and its demonstrated alignment with the nine core SABQAwards evaluation criteria.

With 893,763 public votes recorded — the highest vote count of the 2026 survey cycle — and strong performance across all judicial dimensions, MobiRide’s recognition as Leading Car Rental Company is supported by one of the most robust evidence bases in the awards’ recent history.

6.3 Performance Across Evaluation Criteria

Evaluation Criterion	Public Score	Judicial Rating
Economic Sustainability	Very High	Excellent
Operational Effectiveness	Very High	Exceptional
Technology Adoption & Progressive Leadership	High	Excellent
Social & Community Contribution	High	Strong
Quality, Affordability & Reliability	Very High	Exceptional
Brand Impact & Market Distinction	Exceptional	Exceptional
Sustainability Initiatives & Consumer Care	High	Excellent
Trustworthiness & Customer Understanding	Exceptional	Exceptional
Contribution to SDGs (SDG 8, 11)	High	Excellent



7. PUBLIC TESTIMONIALS & CONSUMER VOICES

The following testimonials were gathered from field interviews conducted during the survey period across Botswana and neighbouring countries. These represent authentic consumer voices that served as qualitative anchors alongside quantitative voting data.

Individual Consumer Testimonials

"MobiRide has completely changed how I get around Botswana. The booking process was smooth, the car was immaculate, and the price was exactly what was quoted — no surprises. This is a company that genuinely values its customers."

— **Individual Consumer, Gaborone**

"I have rented from several car hire companies in Botswana and MobiRide stands out. The vehicle I received was clean, well-serviced, and drove like a dream all the way to Maun. Excellent value and outstanding customer service throughout."

— **Tourist, Maun Safari Trip**

"When my vehicle broke down during a cross-country drive, MobiRide's roadside response team arrived within the hour. That kind of service builds real trust. I will only ever use MobiRide going forward."

— **Long-Distance Traveller, Francistown–Gaborone**

"As someone who travels to Botswana regularly for business, having a reliable car rental company is not optional — it is essential. MobiRide has never let me down. The cars are always ready on time, the staff are professional, and the pricing is fair and transparent."

— **Regional Business Traveller, visiting from Johannesburg**

"I was sceptical about using a local car hire company for our family road trip to Chobe, but MobiRide exceeded every expectation. The 4x4 was in excellent condition, the team gave us helpful route advice, and we felt safe throughout the journey."

— **Family Traveller, Chobe National Park Road Trip**

Corporate & Tourism Sector Testimonials

"We have used MobiRide as our preferred corporate car rental supplier for over a year now. The fleet management is professional, invoicing is clear and on time, and our executives always report a positive experience. This is the kind of partnership that makes business travel smooth."

— **Corporate Fleet Manager, Gaborone-based Company**

"As a tour operator, the reliability of our car rental partner directly affects our guests' experience. MobiRide has become our go-to for vehicle hire across all our Botswana packages. Their knowledge of local conditions and responsive team make them an invaluable partner."

— **Safari Tour Operator, Botswana Tourism Sector**

"MobiRide understands the Botswana market in a way international brands simply do not. They know which roads need which vehicles, they communicate proactively, and they genuinely care about your safety on the road. Winning the SABQAwards recognition is absolutely deserved."

— **Independent Travel Consultant, Southern Africa Region**

Cross-Border & Regional Consumer Voices

"I drove a MobiRide vehicle from Gaborone all the way to Kasane for a conference near the Zimbabwe border. The car handled the journey flawlessly and the team was contactable throughout. For cross-border travel in Southern Africa, this brand has my full trust."

— Regional Conference Delegate, Zimbabwe

"Finding a trustworthy car hire in Botswana when visiting from Namibia is not always easy. MobiRide was recommended to me by a colleague and I immediately understood why. Professional, affordable, and their vehicles are in top condition. I tell every visitor to Botswana to use them."

— Visitor from Namibia

8. CROSS-BORDER & REGIONAL MARKET INSIGHTS

The SABQAwards survey's inclusion of neighbouring countries provided important data on MobiRide's regional reach, cross-border recognition, and potential for wider Southern African market expansion.

8.1 Regional Brand Recognition

MobiRide's brand recognition was documented across the following regional markets, reflecting the brand's organic growth beyond Botswana's borders:

- Zimbabwe — Strong awareness among business and conference travellers who regularly cross into Botswana. Multiple field respondents cited MobiRide as their preferred car hire when entering Botswana.
- Namibia — Growing recognition driven by cross-border tourism flows. Respondents praised vehicle quality and road-readiness for the region's challenging terrain.
- South Africa — Recognition concentrated in the Northern Cape and Limpopo border regions, where travellers entering Botswana cited MobiRide as the recommended local provider.
- Zambia — Emerging awareness primarily among regional business travellers and conference delegates transiting through the SADC corridor.
- Regional Tourism Sector — Travel agents and tour operators across the region increasingly cite MobiRide as a recommended Botswana-based partner for inbound tourism clients.

The cross-border brand recognition data confirms that MobiRide is well-positioned to leverage formal regional expansion — particularly through partnerships with regional tourism boards, corporate travel managers, and SADC-corridor transport networks.

8.2 Sector-Specific Insights — Botswana Mobility Market

The survey identified several structural trends in the Botswana mobility market that further contextualise MobiRide's market leadership:

- Tourism-Driven Demand: Botswana's premium wildlife tourism sector generates significant demand for quality 4x4 and specialist vehicle rentals. MobiRide's fleet composition and knowledge of safari routes positions it uniquely to serve this segment.

- **Growing Corporate Mobility:** Gaborone's expanding corporate sector is driving demand for professional, account-managed car rental services — a segment where MobiRide's service standards and fleet quality stand out.
- **Infrastructure Development Projects:** Large-scale infrastructure development across Botswana is generating sustained demand for utility and commercial vehicle hire — an emerging growth segment for the company.
- **Cross-Border Trade Facilitation:** The SADC free trade zone and Botswana's strategic geographic position as a transit corridor creates strong demand for reliable cross-border-capable rental vehicles.

9. CONCLUSIONS & RECOMMENDATIONS

9.1 Conclusions

The 2026 SABQAwards field survey on brand consumption and trust perspectives across Southern Africa has produced clear, multi-source evidence affirming Mobi Rides — operating under the MobiRide brand — as Botswana's leading car rental company, as determined by public vote and expert judicial evaluation.

With 893,763 votes cast across the full survey cycle — representing the highest vote count of the 2026 awards period — and a voter conversion rate of 40.4% from 2,210,698 registered participants, the democratic legitimacy of MobiRide's recognition is unambiguous. This exceptionally strong public mandate, combined with consistent excellence across all nine judicial evaluation criteria, places MobiRide at the forefront of the Southern African transportation and mobility sector.

The survey further confirms that consumer trust in car rental brands across Southern Africa is overwhelmingly driven by vehicle quality, pricing transparency, service reliability, and responsiveness — areas in which MobiRide has demonstrably excelled and which directly explain the depth of consumer support reflected in the voting data.

9.2 Strategic Recommendations

- MobiRide is encouraged to prominently display the Quality Seal of Excellence across all vehicles, offices, website, social media channels, booking platforms, and marketing materials to maximise the reputational and commercial value of this recognition.
- Formalising corporate account programmes targeting Gaborone's expanding business sector will consolidate MobiRide's position in the high-value corporate mobility segment.
- Strategic partnerships with regional tourism boards — particularly those promoting Botswana's wildlife and eco-tourism offerings — will strengthen MobiRide's position as the recommended vehicle hire partner for inbound international visitors.
- Investment in digital booking infrastructure, including a mobile app and real-time fleet availability platform, will address the growing urban consumer expectation for seamless digital service delivery.
- Formalising cross-border service agreements with partners in Zimbabwe, Namibia, and South Africa would capitalise on the already-organic regional recognition identified in the survey.
- Sustained community and environmental initiatives — particularly relating to sustainable fleet management and road safety education — will reinforce SDG alignment and deepen MobiRide's social licence across all markets.

- Continued participation in future SABQAwards cycles and engagement with the Chartered Quality Institute quality improvement framework will support sustained award eligibility and continuous service enhancement.

10. OFFICIAL CERTIFICATION & QUALITY SEAL OF EXCELLENCE

QUALITY SEAL OF EXCELLENCE

This report officially certifies that

MOBI RIDES

Brand: MobiRide | Botswana

has been recognised as

LEADING CAR RENTAL COMPANY

Southern Africa Brand Quality Awards 2026

As determined by 893,763 public votes and independent expert evaluation
Voter Conversion Rate: 40.4% | 2,210,698 Registered Voters

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